

21st Century

Students should have an understanding of:

2.1	The importance and purpose of marriage in Islam: the significance of marriage in Muslim life; Muslim teachings about marriage, including Surah 4; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to the importance of marriage in society, including a lack of importance, cohabitation and Muslim responses to these attitudes.
2.2	Muslim teaching about the importance of sexual relationships: divergent Muslim teaching about sexual relationships as fulfilling physical, emotional and spiritual needs; Muslim teachings on sexual relationships outside of marriage, including Surah 23:5–11 and same-sex sexual relationships; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to sexual relationships, including the acceptance of sexual relationships outside marriage and same-sex sexual relationships and Muslim responses to them.
2.3	Muslim teaching about the purpose and importance of the family: Muslim teaching about the purpose of families, including Surah 46:15–18: procreation and the strengthening of the ummah; divergent Muslim responses to the different types of family within 21st-century society (nuclear, single parent, same-sex parents, extended and blended families).
2.4	Support for the family in the ummah: how and why the community tries to support families, including through worship, rites of passage, classes for parents, groups for children and counselling; divergent understandings of the importance of this support for Muslims today and how it might strengthen the ummah, with reference to Surah 3:102–105.
2.5	Muslim teaching on contraception: divergent Muslim teachings and attitudes about contraception and family planning, including reference to Sahih al-Bukhari 34:432, and 62:136; different non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to family planning and the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Muslim responses to them.
2.6	Muslim teaching about divorce: divergent Muslim beliefs, teachings and attitudes towards divorce and remarriage, including Surah 2:226–241 and the different rules for performing a divorce in Shi’a and Sunni Islam; different non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to divorce and remarriage, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Muslim responses to them.
2.7	Muslim teaching about the equality of men and women in the family: divergent Muslim beliefs, teachings and attitudes about the role of men and women in the family with reference to the Qur’an, including Surah 4 and the time of Muhammad.
2.8	Muslim teachings about gender prejudice and discrimination: Muslim attitudes to gender prejudice and discrimination, including Surah 33:35; examples of gender equality in action in Islam.

Paper 3: Area of Study 3 – Philosophy and Ethics

- First assessment: May/June 2018.
- The assessment is 50 minutes.
- The assessment is out of 51 marks.
- Students must answer all sections and all questions on the chosen religion.
- The paper may include short open, open response and extended writing questions.
- The paper will assess spelling, punctuation and grammar (SPaG) and use of specialist terminology and these will contribute a minimum of 5% of marks towards the overall weighting for this paper.

Synoptic assessment

Synoptic assessment requires students to work across different parts of a qualification and to show their accumulated knowledge and understanding of a topic or subject area.

Synoptic assessment enables students to show their ability to combine their skills, knowledge and understanding with breadth and depth of the subject.

Synopticity will be assessed where students are required to bring together their knowledge and understanding of religion from across the course of study.

Sample assessment materials

Sample papers and mark schemes can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE (9–1) in Religious Studies A Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs)* document.